PassFrame
TUITION

# The Stranger at the Anchor Inn

Year 5 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

## Extract — read it carefully before answering

The stranger arrived at the Anchor Inn on a wild October evening, when the wind howled like a wolf around the chimney pots and rain lashed the windows in grey sheets. He was a broad man with a scarred cheek and a sea-chest so heavy it took two stable boys to carry it indoors.

'A room,' he growled to my father, dropping a handful of coins onto the counter, 'and quiet. I want no visitors, no questions, and no talk of ships.'

From that first night, strange habits followed him. Every morning he walked alone along the cliff path with a brass spyglass tucked under his arm, scanning the grey horizon as though he expected, at any moment, to see a sail appear. Every evening he sat by the fire with a mug of rum, singing fragments of an old sea-shanty under his breath, and his eyes — pale as winter sky — would dart to the door at the smallest sound.

I was only a boy then, but I noticed things grown-ups often missed. I noticed how his hand trembled, just slightly, whenever a sailor passed through the village. I noticed the long, puckered scar that ran from his ear to his collar, and the way he flinched if anyone asked about it. Most of all, I noticed that he never once, in all his weeks at the inn, told anyone his real name.

It was my mother who first called him Captain, though nobody had given him the title. Somehow, it simply fitted — and somehow, we all understood, without quite knowing why, that danger had followed him through our door.

## Questions

*25 min · 12 questions*

**1.** Who is telling this story — an adult, or someone who was a child at the time?

**2.** What did the stranger scan the horizon for every morning?

**3.** Underline the sentence that tells you the stranger sang quietly in the evenings.

**4.** Underline the sentence that describes the scar on the stranger's face.

**5.** What does “flinched” mean as used in the extract?

**6.** Put these events in order: the stranger pays for a room / the stranger walks the cliff path / the villagers nickname him “Captain” / the narrator notices his trembling hand.

**7.** Why might the author have chosen weather like wind “howling like a wolf” to open the story?

**8.** What object did the stranger always carry on his walks?

**9.** Why do you think the stranger's eyes “would dart to the door at the smallest sound”?

**10.** What does the stranger's reaction to sailors passing through the village suggest about him?

**11.** Find and copy a word that means “a low, rough sound” (used to describe how he spoke).

**12.** Do you think the villagers were right to be cautious of the stranger? Explain your answer using evidence.